

280 PARK AVENUE
NEW YORK, N. Y. 10017
(212) 732-1040

20, PLACE VENDÔME, 75001 PARIS
TELEPHONE 266.17.99

66 GRESHAM ST., LONDON EC2V 7LB
TELEPHONE (01) 600 6691

AVENUE LOUISE, 89.1050 BRUSSELS
TELEPHONE 38.00.70

WHITE & CASE

14 WALL STREET

NEW YORK, N. Y. 10005

(212) 732-1040

CABLES

TELEX

WHITECASE NEW YORK 126201
233188

WHITECASE, PARIS 22242

WHITECASE, LONDON 884757

WHITECASE, BRUSSELS 23100

MJE:C

May 2, 1973

Mr. Kingman Brewster, Jr.
President of Yale University
Woodbridge Hall
105 Wall Street
New Haven, Connecticut

Dear King:

Last week I had a visit from three Puerto Rican students at Yale. Their primary spokesman was Manuel del Valle '74 Law.

The thrust of their discussion was that Yale had a great potential to create the most distinguished Puerto Rican Studies Department in the United States, but that this potential was not being realized. The importance of such studies, they say, is emphasized by the facts, among others, that there are 12,000 Puerto Ricans in New Haven and 1,800,000 on the Eastern seaboard.

They propose the creation of a Puerto Rican Studies Department at Yale and discussed this with me in some detail. At the time they saw me their biggest concern was that they had been unable to discuss the matter with you, but I heard from them last Friday that they have an appointment to meet with you on May 9th.

I was favorably impressed by the enthusiasm and articulateness of their representation, and I am sure that you will be, too.

I told them that I would write you, adding that I didn't think it would influence you one way or the other, but I did say I was sure you would be sympathetic to their problem if they could get to meet with you. However, I pointed out that with the other demands on the University's facilities and finances, it may be very difficult to work out in whole or to any significant extent what they would like to see. They did seem to be willing to make substantial efforts themselves to seek funding from foundations, etc., for what they propose, and with their enthusiasm they might be able to do it. I suggested that possibly the University might be able to suggest some foundations, etc., that they might fruitfully approach.

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